6. What to do if you think you've been spiked?

If you or a friend think you've been spiked: [3-5,7,8]

- Let a member of staff or security know if you're in a venue such as a club, bar, or at a festival.
- If there is evidence like a drink or needle, keep hold of it if you can.
- Get somewhere you feel safe and stay together.
- You may want to report it to the police or seek medical attention first.
- If you need urgent medical attention, call an ambulance (999) or find your nearest urgent care service here.
- Go home with people that you trust or trusted groups or services until the effects wear off.
- Get someone you trust to stay with you until the effects of the alcohol/drugs wear off – this can take a few hours.

If you decide to report it to the police, they may collect forensic samples, e.g. urine, to test for drugs, up to 4 days after the incident. Even if you were tested in a hospital or by your GP for treatment, the police will still ask you to have a forensic test if you report within this 4-day timeframe, as this test can be used as evidence[7] in a criminal investigation.

If you think you have been spiked with a needle, you may be advised to speak to your GP or a sexual health clinic to be tested for blood borne viruses – although the risk of contracting one from a spiking incident is low[10].